Mid scale: painted world, neon information

Samples for Commandos-style missions with X-COM colours, and the green highlight language.

Summary. Following your answers, the mid scale (spy and special-operations missions, border patrols) gets an isometric, painted-style world: the structure of Commandos (isometric view, portrait strip, vertical levels, readable terrain) with the colour and mood of X-COM (cool desaturated nights, warm lamp light, glowing cyan interface frames). To keep the game recognisable, everything the player has to *read* stays in the neon language of the other scales: sight cones, range outlines, orders as green squares joined by white lines, the interface frame and the four meters. The result: **the world is painted, the information is neon.** The green glow marks what is yours and active. These are procedurally drawn mock-ups, not engine footage.

Which look for which mission

Mission style	Look	Why
Stealth, infiltration, assassination (Acts I and II, special operations in any act)	Painted isometric world with neon information layer	Height, cover, doors and sight lines matter most; the painted view makes sneaking readable and atmospheric
Skirmish and firefight, fast tactical planning	Neon top-down (the current game), optionally with the painted terrain	Maximum planning clarity; the preview and replay are the point
Operational campaign (Acts III to V)	Neon hex map with counters	Scale and information first
Global exchange (Act VI)	Neon vector world map	Calm, business-like mood
Drill-down from the hex map	Either close look, chosen by mission type	Stealth raids open painted; firefights open neon



Spy mission, Vienna, night. Painted blocks with lit windows and lamp glow, agents in green halos (the selected one has a double ring, a flag and a name), guards with sight cones, the selected agent's movement range as a glowing outline, a path with order squares, portrait strip, an action bar with a context tip, and the four meters.



Border patrol, snow and forest. Outdoor terrain at dawn, a river with a bridge, a watchtower with its searchlight cone, an observation post flagged in yellow. Cool, desaturated colours, with warm accents kept for lights.



Special operation, docks, vertical. A ship, a crane, containers and a warehouse roof. The overwatch agent on the roof is highlighted at roof height, with a line of sight to the pier. Magenta shadows and orange lamps give the X-COM night mood.



Highlight language. Ready (single green ring), selected (double ring, flag, name, portrait frame), done (dim ring and a check), enemy seen (red ring and cone), enemy last known (dashed red ring and '?'), objective (yellow flag), neutral (yellow ring). Top row: who is acting. YOUR PLAN glows green, OPPONENT PLANS red, REPLAY cyan.

The green glow system

- **Green always means yours and able to act.** The more green, the more it can do: a ring for ready, a double ring and flag for selected.
- **Who is acting** is shown for the whole screen: the frame glows green on your plan, red while the opponent plans, cyan during a replay.
- **In hotseat and on the other side,** the active player is still green. The colours never swap.
- **Done units dim** and show a check, so you can see at a glance what still needs an order.

Honest limits

- These are drawn with a script: textured isometric boxes, soft lighting, colour grading and a neon layer on top. They approximate a painted look. The true hand-painted detail of Commandos needs an artist or an art pipeline.
- What I can build in Godot is the engine for it: isometric rendering, lighting, shadows, height levels, view cones, range outlines, and a library of stylised assets. How far the assets are polished is a later decision.
- The figures here are simple. If this direction is right, the next step would be a better figure style and a short animation test.

Questions

- Which sample is closest to what you imagine, and what should change in it?
- Should all stealth and infiltration missions use this painted look, with the neon top-down view kept for firefights?
- How far toward true painted detail do you want to go, knowing it may need an artist later?